SPELL SCROLL (5E, 2024 RULES) – DEFINITION

Spell Scroll – Scroll, rarity varies.
A Spell Scroll bears the words of **a single spell**, written in a mystical cipher.

- If the spell is on **your spell list**, you can read the scroll and cast its spell **without Material components**. Otherwise, the scroll is unintelligible.
- Casting the spell takes its **normal casting time**. Once cast, the scroll crumbles to dust. If the casting is interrupted, the scroll is not lost.
- If the spell is on your list but of a level you can't cast, make an **ability check with your spellcasting ability: DC 10 + the spell's level**. On a failure, the spell disappears from the scroll with no other effect.
- The **spell's level** sets the save DC, the attack bonus, and the rarity (table below).

Spell level	Rarity	Save DC	Attack bonus
Cantrip	Common	13	+5
1	Common	13	+5
2	Uncommon	13	+5
3	Uncommon	15	+7
4	Rare	15	+7
5	Rare	17	+9
6	Very Rare	17	+9
7	Very Rare	18	+10
8	Very Rare	18	+10
9	Legendary	19	+11

Copying a scroll into a spellbook. A Wizard spell on a scroll can be copied into a spellbook. The copier succeeds on an **Intelligence (Arcana) check, DC 10 + the spell's level**: the spell is copied. Whether or not the check succeeds, the scroll is destroyed.

Step 1 – Identify the scroll:

A Spell Scroll is a magic item: **Detect Magic** spots it, and the **Identify** spell or a Short Rest reveals its contents (see the **Identifying a Magic Item** and **Magic Items and Cursed Items** sheets).

Step 2 – Check you can read it:

The spell must be on **your spell list**. Otherwise, the scroll is unintelligible.

Step 3 – Compare the spell's level:

If you can cast spells of that level, go to step 4. Otherwise, make a spellcasting ability check against **DC 10 + the spell's level**. A failure erases the spell from the scroll.

Example: Léa (level 3 Wizard, Int +4) reads a scroll of Fireball (level 3), too high for her. DC 13: she rolls 8 + 4 = 12. Failure, the spell disappears.

Step 4 – Cast the spell:

- Normal casting time of the spell, no Material component.
- The spell is cast **without a spell slot**.
- Save DC and attack bonus come from the **table**, by the scroll's level.

Step 5 – After the casting:

- Once the spell is cast, the scroll crumbles to dust.
- If the casting is interrupted, the scroll is not lost.

Step 6 – Copy the spell (Wizard):

Intelligence (Arcana) DC 10 + the spell's level. Success: the spell is copied into the spellbook. In every case, the scroll is destroyed.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes

Table rule

The text doesn't say at what level the spell is cast or whether it can be boosted with a slot. Fix: the **DM announces it is cast at the scroll's level**.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the glowing ink, the words rising off the scroll, then the paper crumbling to dust.

Questions:

Do I need a spell slot?

No: spell scrolls and other magic items hold spells that are cast without a slot.

Which DC and attack bonus do I use?

Those on the table, by the inscribed spell's level, not your own.

What if the spell isn't on my list?

The scroll is unintelligible: you can't cast it.

Can a character without spells read one?

No, barring a special feature. The level 13 Thief (Rogue) can use any scroll with Intelligence: a cantrip or level 1 spell automatically, otherwise an Intelligence (Arcana) check, DC 10 + the spell's level.

Can I copy a Cleric spell into a spellbook?

No: only a Wizard spell can be copied into a spellbook.

Does copying also cost time and gold?

A Wizard pays 2 hours and 50 GP per level to copy a spell into their spellbook. The scroll text is silent on this: the DM decides. Table rule

Does Detect Magic detect the scroll?

Yes, it is a magic item. An ordinary spellbook is not one in itself. See the **Detect Magic** sheet.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Scroll and class list

A Bard can use a scroll of a spell from another list (Cleric, Druid, Wizard) only if it is prepared through Magical Secrets; otherwise it is illegible.

Spell level

A spell cast without a slot is cast at its lowest level, unless stated otherwise.

Components

A spell consumes its components only if its description says so.

Notices: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2.1 ("SRD 5.2.1") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2.1 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode. Unofficial sheet, 5E compatible (2024 rules), neither approved nor sponsored by Wizards of the Coast. Rules come from SRD 5.2.1; where the SRD gives no answer, explanations rely on our own interpretation. The "Table rule" parts are the author's own creations. Borders, banner, texture, titles, layout, table rules and examples: © Jaja, all rights reserved. Sources: SRD 5.2.1 (official English version); rule clarifications cross-checked with answers found on the web and reworded; numeric examples are invented; last revised: November 2026. Fonts: TeX Gyre Pagella (GUST), DejaVu Sans, Noto Color Emoji (OFL).